of their messages and propaganda, as well as their threats, thus sowing fear and terror and adding to the instability and uncertainty that already exist in the world.

An important question that concerns all those dealing with the phenomenon of terrorism is whether it is indeed a threat to the state's national security (Israel included). In the past, terrorism was a local problem—its objectives were local, and therefore so was its influence. Today it affects the entire world. And since the world is a global village, terrorism in one place may have an effect on the entire world order. In the past, terrorists used relatively simple weapons and combat doctrines, which also led to their influence remaining local. Today, we do not rule out the possibility that global terrorist groups will use nonconventional weapons, including cyber warfare. Plainly, nonconventional weapons threaten the national security of states. These threats, if they materialize, will certainly have strategic significance. These are "hardware" threats. Then there is the question of whether global terrorism can have a strategic effect in the area of "software": in other words, whether terrorism can attain strategic goals by harming the national resilience of a people or a state.

One of terrorism's main goals is to sow fear and terror among the civilian population in order to ultimately damage national resilience. A concrete example of how this may harm national security is if the vulnerable public puts pressure on its leaders to make decisions that clearly conflict with the interests of the state but do serve the interests of the terrorists. If a terrorist organization succeeds in creating such a process and outcome, there is no doubt it will thereby be achieving a strategic triumph. This scenario may sound purely theoretical, but it is not: it is palpably relevant to the Jewish population of Israel, which has been dealing with the phenomenon of terrorism since the establishment of the state seventy years ago, as well as during the eighty years preceding the state, with the beginning of Zionist settlement in Israel. I am touching on this issue only cursorily, but decision makers must take it in hand and monitor it over time so that they or their successors aren't surprised to find themselves one day suddenly facing a desperate situation. This insight is based on the assumption that a continued terrorist campaign against an entire population over a period of many years may well influence its national resilience.

The attack on the World Trade Center in Manhattan on September 11, 2001, was a milestone in the history of global jihadist terrorism, as it